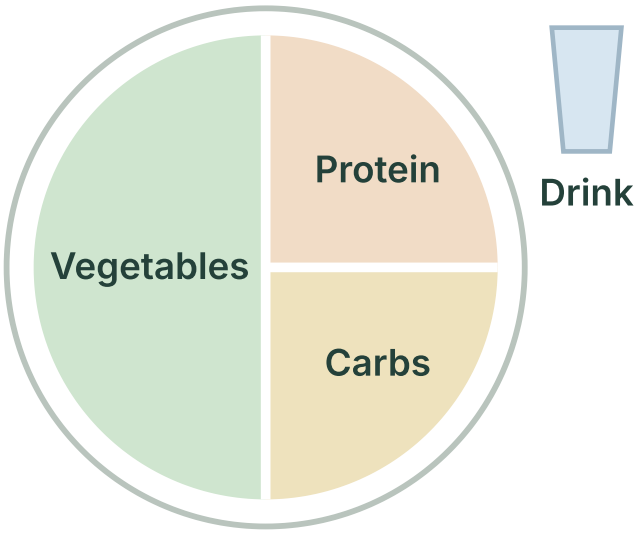
A free printable companion to *You Have Prediabetes. Now What?*

Anchor Meals

Twelve meals for one or two, a sample week, and pages to plan your own



Half vegetables. A quarter protein. A quarter carbohydrate foods. A drink without sugar.

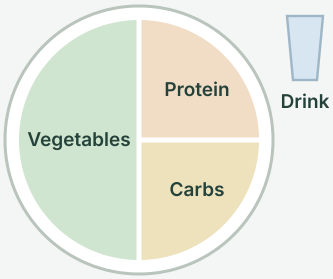
Jonathan Crowell, FNP

How to use these pages

Chapter 6 of the book gave you the plate: half non-starchy vegetables, a quarter protein, a quarter carbohydrate foods, and a drink without sugar. These twelve meals show that plate in real food, so you can see it before you build your own. They're worked examples, not a menu. Cook the ones that sound good, change what you like, and skip the rest.

Every meal serves one or two, or makes enough to eat twice. The ingredients come from an ordinary grocery store, and most use frozen or canned vegetables somewhere, because they keep for months and cost less than fresh ones that wilt before you get to them.

Each meal names the eating pattern from Chapter 5 it fits most closely, with a line on how to shift it toward each of the others. Under each one are the two lines Chapter 6 taught you to read on a label, fiber and added sugars, along with carbohydrate, protein, and sodium. They're per serving, and they're estimates; the last page explains where they come from.



What's here

Twelve meals, one to a page, each with a plate sketch, a shopping checklist, the steps, and the numbers.

A sample week that shows how the meals fit together, with cook-once nights and leftover lunches.

A blank week and a shopping page to print as often as you like.

The meals

	MEAL	WHEN	PATTERN	PAGE
1	Eggs with Peppers and Spinach	Breakfast	Prevention program	6
2	Yogurt Bowl with Nuts and Berries	Breakfast	Mediterranean	7
3	Overnight Oats with Peanut Butter	Breakfast	Plant-forward	8
4	The No-Stove Plate	Lunch	Any	9
5	The Lunch Cooler	Lunch	Prevention program	10
6	Taco Bowl	Lunch or supper	Plant-forward	11
7	Sheet-Pan Chicken and Vegetables	Supper	Prevention program	12
8	A Pot of Beans, Two Suppers	Supper	Plant-forward	13
9	Sunday Pot Roast, More Vegetables in the Pot	Supper	Any	14
10	Fish with Frozen Vegetables and Brown Rice	Supper	Mediterranean	15
11	Skillet Ground Meat with Cabbage and Peppers	Supper	Lower-carbohydrate	16
12	Lentil Soup That Freezes	Supper	Plant-forward	17

A sample week

One way the twelve meals fit together. Three nights you cook something big, and the leftovers carry lunch and a second supper. The numbers are the meal numbers in this guide.

	BREAKFAST	LUNCH	SUPPER	COOK OR PREP
Sunday	1 · Eggs with peppers and spinach	4 · The no-stove plate	9 · Sunday pot roast	Cook the roast. Make the oat jars tonight.
Monday	3 · Overnight oats	5 · The lunch cooler	9 · Pot roast, second night	
Tuesday	2 · Yogurt bowl	9 · Pot roast leftovers	7 · Sheet-pan chicken	Cook once, eat twice.
Wednesday	3 · Overnight oats	5 · The lunch cooler	8 · A pot of beans	Start the beans when you get home. They simmer on their own for about 2 hours.
Thursday	1 · Eggs with peppers and spinach	6 · Taco bowl, with Wednesday's beans	11 · Skillet with cabbage and peppers	
Friday	2 · Yogurt bowl	7 · Sheet-pan leftovers	10 · Fish with frozen vegetables	Make oat jars tonight.
Saturday	3 · Overnight oats	6 · Taco bowl, with the rest of the beans	12 · Lentil soup	Freeze the soup you won't eat in 3 days.

Cooking for two

The week works as written. The pot roast, sheet-pan chicken, skillet, and fish already make enough for two, and the pot of beans covers Wednesday's supper and both taco bowls. Double the breakfasts and the packed lunches.

Cooking for one

Make the taco bowl once on Thursday and eat the second serving Saturday. Halve the sheet-pan chicken and the fish. Freeze the extra pot roast, beans, skillet, and soup in single portions, and you'll have suppers ready for nights when nothing else is.

Swap any day for another. If Thursday falls apart, eat Friday's supper and move on; the plan is there to make the next meal easier, not to grade the last one.

My week

Write in an anchor meal, a leftover, or anything else that fits the plate.

Week of _____

	BREAKFAST	LUNCH	SUPPER	COOK OR PREP
Sunday				
Monday				
Tuesday				
Wednesday				
Thursday				
Friday				
Saturday				

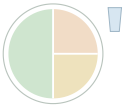


Plate check: half non-starchy vegetables, a quarter protein, a quarter carbohydrate foods, and a drink without sugar.

Shopping

Keep on hand

Everything the twelve meals use, by section of the store. Most of it keeps, so a stocked kitchen turns any of the meals into a short trip.

PRODUCE

Bell peppers, onions, garlic, carrots or baby carrots, celery, cucumber, tomatoes, lettuce, cabbage or coleslaw mix, snap peas, mushrooms, zucchini, sweet potatoes, small red potatoes, apples, oranges, lemons, limes

FROZEN

Broccoli, spinach, collards or other greens, berries, brown rice, fish fillets

CANNED AND DRY

Dry pinto beans, low-sodium canned beans, dry lentils, tuna pouches, no-salt-added diced tomatoes, low-sodium broth, old-fashioned oats, chia seeds, peanut butter, walnuts, whole-grain crackers, salsa, olive oil

DAIRY AND EGGS

Eggs, plain Greek yogurt, milk or unsweetened soy milk, shredded cheddar, hummus

MEAT

Boneless chicken thighs, beef chuck roast, 90% lean ground beef or ground turkey, rotisserie chicken

BREAD

Whole-grain bread, corn tortillas

SPICES

Cumin, paprika, garlic powder, thyme, cinnamon, salt, pepper

This week's list

PRODUCE

FROZEN

CANNED AND DRY

DAIRY AND EGGS

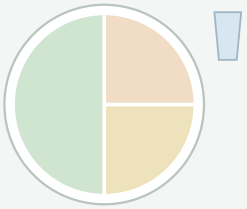
MEAT AND FISH

BREAD

OTHER

1 Eggs with Peppers and Spinach

Breakfast | Prevention program pattern | Serves 1. Double everything for two.



- **Vegetables:** peppers and spinach
- **Protein:** eggs
- **Carbohydrate:** toast and berries
- **Drink:** water, or another drink without sugar

You'll need

- [ ] 2 large eggs
- [ ] 1/2 cup chopped red bell pepper (about half a pepper)
- [ ] 1 cup fresh spinach, or a handful of frozen
- [ ] 1 teaspoon olive oil
- [ ] A pinch of salt and pepper
- [ ] 1 slice whole-grain bread, toasted
- [ ] 1/2 cup blueberries or other berries, fresh or frozen

Steps

1. Warm the oil in a skillet over medium heat. Cook the pepper for about 3 minutes, until it softens.
2. Add the spinach and stir until it wilts, about 1 minute.
3. Crack in the eggs, add the salt and pepper, and stir gently until they're set the way you like them.
4. Serve with the toast and the berries on the side.

Other patterns

- **Mediterranean:** Cook in a little more olive oil and add a few olives or a spoon of feta.
- **Plant-forward:** Use 1/2 cup black beans or crumbled tofu in place of one or both eggs.
- **Lower-carbohydrate:** Skip the toast and keep the berries, or keep the toast and skip the berries.

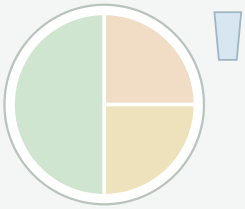
My notes

PER SERVING	31 g CARBOHYDRATE	6 g FIBER	0 g ADDED SUGARS	19 g PROTEIN	470 mg SODIUM

Added sugars: 0 g from the recipe; check the label on your bread.

2 Yogurt Bowl with Nuts and Berries

Breakfast | Mediterranean pattern | Serves 1. No cooking.



- **Vegetables:** cucumber and tomatoes on the side
- **Protein:** plain Greek yogurt and walnuts
- **Carbohydrate:** berries and oats
- **Drink:** water, or another drink without sugar

You'll need

- [ ] 3/4 cup plain Greek yogurt, low-fat
- [ ] 1/2 cup blueberries or other berries, fresh or frozen
- [ ] 2 tablespoons chopped walnuts
- [ ] 2 tablespoons old-fashioned rolled oats
- [ ] 1/2 cup sliced cucumber
- [ ] 5 cherry tomatoes

Steps

1. Spoon the yogurt into a bowl.
2. Top with the berries, walnuts, and oats. Frozen berries can thaw in the bowl while you get ready.
3. Put the cucumber and tomatoes on the side. It's the easiest way to get vegetables in before noon.

Other patterns

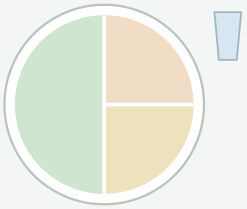
- **Prevention program:** Use nonfat yogurt and keep the rest the same.
- **Plant-forward:** Use a plain soy yogurt and add a spoon of chia seeds.
- **Lower-carbohydrate:** Halve the berries, skip the oats, and add a few more walnuts.

My notes

PER SERVING	31 g CARBOHYDRATE	5 g FIBER	0 g ADDED SUGARS	23 g PROTEIN	60 mg SODIUM

3 Overnight Oats with Peanut Butter

Breakfast | Plant-forward pattern | Serves 1. Make it the night before in a jar or a covered bowl.



- **Vegetables:** berries stand in here (add a vegetable at lunch)
- **Protein:** peanut butter, chia seeds, and milk
- **Carbohydrate:** oats
- **Drink:** water, or another drink without sugar

You'll need

- [ ] 1/2 cup old-fashioned rolled oats
- [ ] 1/2 cup milk, or an unsweetened soy milk
- [ ] 1 tablespoon peanut butter
- [ ] 1 tablespoon chia seeds
- [ ] 1/2 cup berries, fresh or frozen
- [ ] A shake of cinnamon

Steps

1. Stir the oats, milk, peanut butter, chia seeds, and cinnamon together in a jar.
2. Put the berries on top, cover, and refrigerate overnight.
3. In the morning, stir and eat it cold, or warm it for a minute in the microwave.

> Make two or three jars at once. They keep about 3 days in the refrigerator.

Other patterns

- **Mediterranean:** Use walnuts or almonds in place of the peanut butter.
- **Prevention program:** Use 1% milk and keep the peanut butter to the one tablespoon.
- **Lower-carbohydrate:** Use 1/4 cup oats and add 1/4 cup plain Greek yogurt.

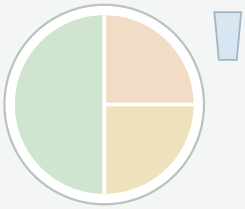
My notes

PER SERVING	52 g CARBOHYDRATE	11 g FIBER	0 g ADDED SUGARS	17 g PROTEIN	130 mg SODIUM

Added sugars: 0 g from the recipe; check the label on your peanut butter.

4 The No-Stove Plate

Lunch · Any pattern · Serves 1.



- **Vegetables:** lettuce, tomato, and a handful of raw vegetables
- **Protein:** chicken (or eggs or beans)
- **Carbohydrate:** whole-grain bread
- **Drink:** water, or another drink without sugar

You'll need

- [ ] 2 slices whole-grain bread
- [ ] 3 ounces cooked chicken, sliced (leftover or rotisserie, skin off)
- [ ] 1 teaspoon mustard
- [ ] 2 lettuce leaves
- [ ] 2 slices tomato
- [ ] 6 baby carrots
- [ ] 1/2 cup snap peas
- [ ] 1/2 cup sliced cucumber

Steps

1. Build the sandwich: bread, mustard, chicken, lettuce, and tomato.
2. Put the carrots, snap peas, and cucumber beside it, or in a bag if it's going with you.
3. No chicken? Two hard-cooked eggs or 1/2 cup mashed beans work the same way.

Other patterns

- **Mediterranean:** Use hummus in place of the mustard and add a few olives.
- **Plant-forward:** Fill it with mashed beans or hummus and extra vegetables.
- **Lower-carbohydrate:** Use one slice of bread, open-faced, or wrap the filling in lettuce.

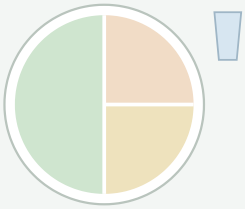
My notes

PER SERVING	39 g CARBOHYDRATE	8 g FIBER	0 g ADDED SUGARS	37 g PROTEIN	460 mg SODIUM

Added sugars: 0 g from the recipe; check the label on your bread.

5 The Lunch Cooler

Lunch | Prevention program pattern | Serves 1. Packs the night before.



- **Vegetables:** cut vegetables with hummus
- **Protein:** tuna (or chicken or eggs)
- **Carbohydrate:** whole-grain crackers and an apple
- **Drink:** water, or another drink without sugar

You'll need

- [ ] 1 pouch or small can tuna, drained (about 3 ounces)
- [ ] 6 whole-grain crackers
- [ ] 2 tablespoons hummus
- [ ] 8 baby carrots
- [ ] 1/2 cup snap peas
- [ ] 1/2 cup bell pepper strips
- [ ] 1 small apple

Steps

1. Pack the vegetables and hummus in one container and the tuna in another.
2. Add the crackers and the apple.
3. Keep it cold with an ice pack, and keep it where you'll see it before you leave work.

Other patterns

- **Mediterranean:** Mix the tuna with a teaspoon of olive oil and a squeeze of lemon.
- **Plant-forward:** Use a cup of leftover beans from meal 8, or more hummus and a hard-cooked egg.
- **Lower-carbohydrate:** Skip the crackers and add a cheese stick or a handful of nuts.

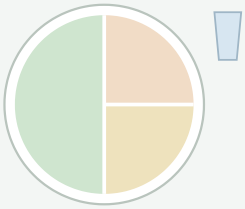
My notes

PER SERVING	56 g CARBOHYDRATE	12 g FIBER	0 g ADDED SUGARS	24 g PROTEIN	630 mg SODIUM

Added sugars: 0 g from the recipe; check the label on your crackers and hummus.

6 Taco Bowl

Lunch or supper | Plant-forward pattern | Serves 2.



- **Vegetables:** peppers, onions, lettuce, and salsa
- **Protein:** black beans and cheese
- **Carbohydrate:** brown rice
- **Drink:** water, or another drink without sugar

You'll need

- [ ] 1 1/2 cups black or pinto beans, from the pot of beans (meal 8) or a can of low-sodium beans, drained and rinsed
- [ ] 2/3 cup cooked brown rice (frozen works)
- [ ] 1 bell pepper, sliced
- [ ] 1/2 onion, sliced
- [ ] 1 teaspoon olive oil
- [ ] 1/2 teaspoon cumin
- [ ] 2 cups shredded lettuce
- [ ] 1/2 cup salsa
- [ ] 1/4 cup shredded cheddar
- [ ] 1/2 lime, cut in wedges

Steps

1. Warm the oil in a skillet over medium-high heat. Cook the pepper and onion until they soften and brown at the edges, about 6 minutes.
2. Add the beans and cumin and stir until the beans are hot.
3. Warm the rice.
4. Divide the lettuce between two bowls. Add the rice, then the beans and vegetables.
5. Top with salsa and cheese, with lime on the side.

> About half of the sodium in this bowl comes from the salsa, so a lower-sodium salsa makes the biggest difference.

Other patterns

- **Mediterranean:** Use chickpeas, cucumber, and a spoon of plain yogurt in place of the cheese.
- **Prevention program:** Use 6 ounces of cooked chicken in place of the beans.
- **Lower-carbohydrate:** Use cauliflower rice or skip the rice, and add more lettuce.

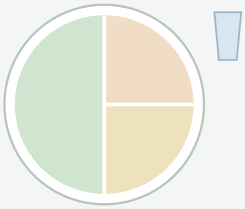
My notes

PER SERVING	62 g CARBOHYDRATE	17 g FIBER	0 g ADDED SUGARS	19 g PROTEIN	860 mg SODIUM

Added sugars: 0 g from the recipe; check the label on your salsa.

7 Sheet-Pan Chicken and Vegetables

Supper | Prevention program pattern | Makes 4 servings: supper for two, twice, or four suppers for one.



- **Vegetables:** broccoli, onion, and pepper
- **Protein:** chicken thighs
- **Carbohydrate:** sweet potato
- **Drink:** water, or another drink without sugar

You'll need

- [ ] 1 pound boneless, skinless chicken thighs (about 4)
- [ ] 4 cups broccoli florets, fresh or frozen
- [ ] 1 red onion, cut in wedges
- [ ] 1 bell pepper, cut in strips
- [ ] 2 medium sweet potatoes, cut in 1-inch cubes
- [ ] 1 1/2 tablespoons olive oil
- [ ] 1/2 teaspoon salt
- [ ] Pepper and garlic powder

Steps

1. Heat the oven to 425 degrees F. Line a large sheet pan with foil if you want easy cleanup.
2. Toss the sweet potatoes with half the oil and a little of the salt. Roast them alone for 10 minutes.
3. Toss the chicken and the other vegetables with the rest of the oil, salt, and seasonings.
4. Add them to the pan and roast 20 to 25 minutes more, until the chicken reaches 165 degrees F inside and the vegetables brown.
5. Eat half now. Refrigerate the rest for up to 3 days.

> This is the cook-once, eat-twice meal from Chapter 6. The second night, it reheats in 2 minutes.

Other patterns

- **Mediterranean:** Season with oregano and lemon, and use zucchini in place of the pepper.
- **Plant-forward:** Use a can of drained chickpeas in place of the chicken; add them for the last 15 minutes.
- **Lower-carbohydrate:** Use one sweet potato and add more broccoli.

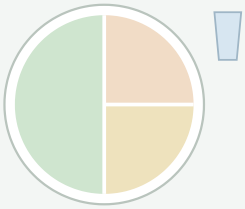
My notes

PER SERVING	24 g CARBOHYDRATE	6 g FIBER	0 g ADDED SUGARS	25 g PROTEIN	450 mg SODIUM

8 A Pot of Beans, Two Suppers

Supper | Plant-forward pattern

The pot makes about 8 servings of beans. Supper for two uses a quarter of it; the rest goes in the refrigerator, the freezer, or the taco bowl.



- **Vegetables:** greens and sliced tomato
- **Protein:** pinto beans
- **Carbohydrate:** a corn tortilla
- **Drink:** water, or another drink without sugar

You'll need

- [ ] 1 pound dry pinto beans, rinsed
- [ ] 1 onion, chopped
- [ ] 3 cloves garlic, smashed
- [ ] 1 teaspoon salt
- [ ] Water to cover by 2 inches
- [ ] Per plate: 1/2 package (5 ounces) frozen collards or other greens, cooked
- [ ] Per plate: half a tomato, sliced
- [ ] Per plate: 1 corn tortilla, warmed

Steps

1. Put the beans, onion, and garlic in a large pot and cover with water by 2 inches. Soaking overnight first shortens the cooking but isn't required.
2. Bring to a boil, then lower the heat and simmer, partly covered, until the beans are soft, about 1 1/2 to 2 1/2 hours. Add water if they get low.
3. Stir in the salt for the last 15 minutes.
4. For supper, cook the greens by the package directions, slice the tomato, and warm the tortillas.
5. Serve 3/4 cup beans per person with the greens, tomato, and a tortilla.
6. Cool the rest and refrigerate up to 4 days, or freeze in 1 1/2-cup containers.

> One pound of dry beans makes this supper twice for two and still leaves beans for the taco bowl (meal 6).

Other patterns

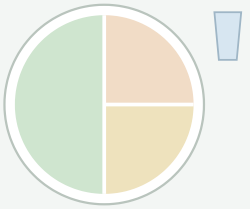
- **Mediterranean:** Cook the greens in olive oil with garlic and finish with lemon.
- **Prevention program:** Keep it as written; it already fits.
- **Lower-carbohydrate:** Skip the tortilla and double the greens.

My notes

PER SERVING	59 g CARBOHYDRATE	16 g FIBER	0 g ADDED SUGARS	18 g PROTEIN	380 mg SODIUM

9 Sunday Pot Roast, More Vegetables in the Pot

Supper | Any pattern | Makes 6 servings. Leftovers keep 3 to 4 days.



- **Vegetables:** carrots, onions, celery, and mushrooms
- **Protein:** beef
- **Carbohydrate:** potatoes
- **Drink:** water, or another drink without sugar

You'll need

- [ ] 2 pounds beef chuck roast, fat trimmed
- [ ] 1 tablespoon oil
- [ ] 1 1/2 pounds carrots, cut in chunks
- [ ] 2 onions, cut in wedges
- [ ] 3 stalks celery, cut in chunks
- [ ] 8 ounces mushrooms, halved
- [ ] 1 pound small red potatoes, halved
- [ ] 2 cups low-sodium broth
- [ ] 2 cloves garlic
- [ ] 1 teaspoon salt, pepper, and a little thyme

Steps

1. Heat the oven to 325 degrees F. Season the roast with half the salt and some pepper.
2. Heat the oil in a Dutch oven or heavy pot and brown the roast on all sides, about 10 minutes.
3. Add the broth, garlic, and thyme. Cover and bake for 1 1/2 hours.
4. Add the vegetables and potatoes around the roast with the rest of the salt. Cover and bake about 1 1/2 hours more, until the beef pulls apart.
5. Serve each plate the Chapter 6 way: vegetables first, so they cover half the plate, then beef and potatoes.

> If your family already has a pot roast recipe, keep it and double the vegetables. A slow cooker works too: 8 hours on low.

Other patterns

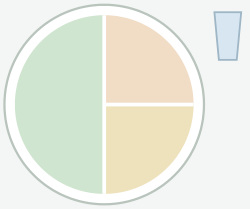
- **Mediterranean:** Use olive oil, add a can of no-salt diced tomatoes, and season with rosemary.
- **Plant-forward:** Serve smaller slices of beef with extra vegetables, or make the same pot with mushrooms and white beans.
- **Lower-carbohydrate:** Use half the potatoes and add a second pound of carrots or a bag of green beans.

My notes

PER SERVING	29 g CARBOHYDRATE	6 g FIBER	0 g ADDED SUGARS	35 g PROTEIN	570 mg SODIUM

10 Fish with Frozen Vegetables and Brown Rice

Supper | Mediterranean pattern | Serves 2. About 20 minutes.



- **Vegetables:** broccoli
- **Protein:** fish
- **Carbohydrate:** brown rice
- **Drink:** water, or another drink without sugar

You'll need

- [ ] 2 fish fillets, about 4 ounces each, fresh or frozen (tilapia, cod, catfish, salmon, or whatever is on sale)
- [ ] 1 bag (12 ounces) frozen broccoli or other frozen vegetable
- [ ] 1 cup cooked brown rice (frozen works)
- [ ] 2 teaspoons olive oil
- [ ] 1/2 lemon
- [ ] 1/4 teaspoon salt, plus pepper and paprika

Steps

1. Heat the oven to 400 degrees F. If the fish is frozen, thaw it in the refrigerator overnight, or under cold running water in its sealed package.
2. Put the fish on a foil-lined pan, brush with 1 teaspoon of the oil, and season with salt, pepper, and paprika.
3. Bake 10 to 15 minutes, until the fish flakes easily with a fork.
4. Meanwhile, cook the vegetables and warm the rice by the package directions. Toss the vegetables with the rest of the oil.
5. Squeeze the lemon over the fish and serve.

Other patterns

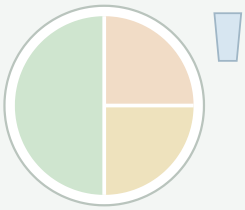
- **Prevention program:** Keep it as written; it already fits.
- **Plant-forward:** Use a can of drained white beans warmed with the vegetables in place of the fish.
- **Lower-carbohydrate:** Use half the rice and add a second vegetable.

My notes

PER SERVING	36 g CARBOHYDRATE	7 g FIBER	0 g ADDED SUGARS	31 g PROTEIN	360 mg SODIUM

11 Skillet Ground Meat with Cabbage and Peppers

Supper | Lower-carbohydrate pattern | Serves 2. One skillet, about 25 minutes.



- **Vegetables:** cabbage, peppers, onion, and tomatoes
- **Protein:** ground beef or turkey
- **Carbohydrate:** an orange for dessert
- **Drink:** water, or another drink without sugar

You'll need

- ☐ 1/2 pound 90% lean ground beef or ground turkey
- ☐ 1 teaspoon oil
- ☐ 1 onion, chopped
- ☐ 1 green bell pepper, chopped
- ☐ 4 cups shredded cabbage (about half a small head, or a bag of coleslaw mix)
- ☐ 1 can (14.5 ounces) no-salt-added diced tomatoes
- ☐ 1 teaspoon paprika or cumin
- ☐ 1/4 teaspoon salt, and pepper
- ☐ 2 oranges

Steps

1. Brown the meat in a large skillet over medium-high heat, breaking it up, about 6 minutes. Pour off any fat.
2. Add the oil, onion, and pepper and cook until soft, about 5 minutes.
3. Add the cabbage and seasonings and stir until the cabbage wilts, about 5 minutes.
4. Add the tomatoes, cover, and simmer 10 minutes.
5. Serve with an orange each after the meal.

Other patterns

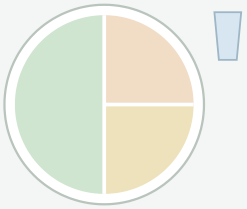
- **Mediterranean:** Use ground turkey, olive oil, and oregano, and finish with a spoon of feta.
- **Prevention program:** Add 1/2 cup brown rice per person.
- **Plant-forward:** Use a can of drained lentils or black beans in place of the meat.

My notes

PER SERVING	41 g CARBOHYDRATE	12 g FIBER	0 g ADDED SUGARS	28 g PROTEIN	410 mg SODIUM

12 Lentil Soup That Freezes

Supper | Plant-forward pattern | Makes 6 servings, about 1 1/2 cups each.



- **Vegetables:** the vegetables in the pot
- **Protein:** lentils
- **Carbohydrate:** lentils (add a slice of whole-grain bread if you want it)
- **Drink:** water, or another drink without sugar

You'll need

- [ ] 1 1/2 cups dry brown or green lentils, rinsed
- [ ] 1 tablespoon olive oil
- [ ] 1 onion, chopped
- [ ] 3 carrots, chopped
- [ ] 3 stalks celery, chopped
- [ ] 1 zucchini, chopped
- [ ] 3 cloves garlic, chopped
- [ ] 1 teaspoon cumin
- [ ] 1 can (14.5 ounces) no-salt-added diced tomatoes
- [ ] 4 cups low-sodium broth plus 2 cups water
- [ ] 1 package (10 ounces) frozen spinach
- [ ] 1/2 teaspoon salt, and lemon juice to finish

Steps

1. Warm the oil in a large pot over medium heat. Cook the onion, carrots, and celery until soft, about 8 minutes.
2. Add the zucchini, garlic, and cumin and stir for 1 minute.
3. Add the lentils, tomatoes, broth, and water. Bring to a boil, then lower the heat and simmer, partly covered, about 30 minutes, until the lentils are tender.
4. Stir in the spinach and salt and cook 5 minutes more. Finish with a squeeze of lemon.
5. Freeze what you won't eat in 3 days in 1 1/2-cup containers.

> Cook once on Sunday; eat it twice that week and freeze the rest for nights when nothing else is ready.

Other patterns

- **Mediterranean:** Finish each bowl with a drizzle of olive oil and a spoon of plain yogurt.
- **Prevention program:** Keep it as written, with a slice of whole-grain bread.
- **Lower-carbohydrate:** Use 1 cup of lentils and add a second zucchini.

My notes

PER SERVING	44 g CARBOHYDRATE	10 g FIBER	0 g ADDED SUGARS	18 g PROTEIN	330 mg SODIUM

About the numbers

The numbers come from the U.S. Department of Agriculture's FoodData Central database, using its Standard Reference Legacy data and the amounts listed in each meal. Yours will differ with brands, with how much fat you trim, and with how full your measuring cup is. Read them as a close estimate rather than a label.

Added sugars aren't reported in that database, so here's how this guide handles them. Eggs, vegetables, fruit, beans, grains, meat, fish, milk, and plain yogurt have none added. Where a meal uses something packaged that can have sugar added, such as bread, peanut butter, crackers, hummus, or salsa, the meal tells you which item to check, and the added sugars line on its label (Chapter 6) has the answer.

If your clinician has asked you to track calories, they're in the table. If counting has ever pulled you toward restricting what you eat (Chapter 7), skip the table; nothing else in these pages depends on it.

Calories per serving

	MEAL	CALORIES
1	Eggs with Peppers and Spinach	330
2	Yogurt Bowl with Nuts and Berries	330
3	Overnight Oats with Peanut Butter	400
4	The No-Stove Plate	360
5	The Lunch Cooler	390
6	Taco Bowl	390
7	Sheet-Pan Chicken and Vegetables	310
8	A Pot of Beans, Two Suppers	310
9	Sunday Pot Roast, More Vegetables in the Pot	340
10	Fish with Frozen Vegetables and Brown Rice	330
11	Skillet Ground Meat with Cabbage and Peppers	370
12	Lentil Soup That Freezes	270

Source: U.S. Department of Agriculture, Agricultural Research Service, Beltsville Human Nutrition Research Center. FoodData Central: SR Legacy. Accessed October 26, 2026. https://fdc.nal.usda.gov/

These pages are for general education and don't replace advice from your own clinician. If you've been given a special eating plan, for your kidneys or anything else, follow it first.

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